

FACT, an award-winning software in our previous accounting software comparison test, was nowhere near last time's performance, this time around.

The software has its advantages; the accounting code that can be assigned with account-heads was appreciated by our accountants. The impression of the expert panel reviewing the software was that FACT was too complex.

When we posted some entries, FACT began giving "no cash/bank codes exists" messages. After going through the help

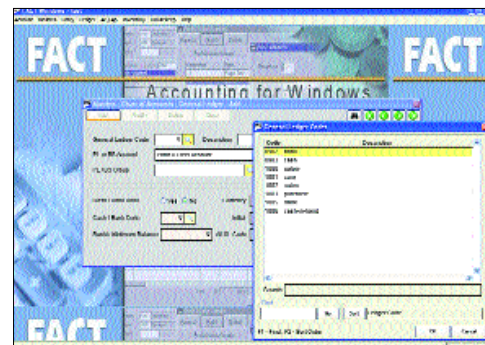
“ Ill planned, complex for laymen, restrictive operations and overpriced ”

files, we realised that FACT expects account codes to be in a particular range—this imposes some restrictions on the user.

The software has most, if not all, of the common features, but the weakest link here is the help and support. The layout of the software appears too hazy with almost no classification

and categorisation of options. At the same time, menu and option names are technical in nature. A user with only basic accounting knowledge is not likely to be familiar with these.

FACT is definitely a no-go.



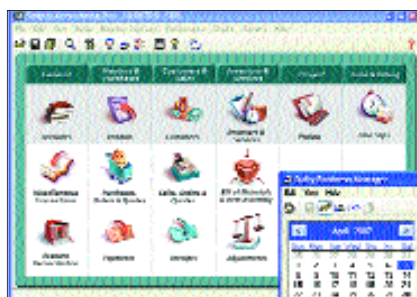
Price: Single user—Rs 30,000, 5 users—Rs 42,500
+ Facility to assign codes to accounts
— Too complex, menu names technical

FACT		B				
Performance		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Features		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Ease of Use		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Overall		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶

Simple Accounting Pro

The learning curve for Simple Accounting Pro (SAP) is on the higher side—takes getting used to.

Once it's installed, you need to either create a new company or work with sample data. The software provides the biggest template list among the software tested. This simplifies the task of creating a new company quickly.



“ Innovative, auditor-friendly, but lacks individual affordability ”

First-time users will have a tough time. You need more than basic accounting knowledge to handle the intricacies of the software. Handling operations related to taxes, chart of accounts, etc., will scare away newbies.

A unique feature in SAP is the 'advice' feature. If the feature is set to auto mode, the software 'advises' you frequently.

An example: if one of your customers is a habitual late-payer, the software warns you. Another interesting utility is Daily Business Management, which helps you maintain a list of activities that needs attention at appropriate times.

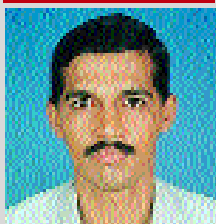
A big plus for SAP is that it provides a complete audit trail, thereby restricting the company from modifying vouchers and falsifying the records.

To summarise, SAP is a good product, but not for beginners.

Price: Single user—Rs 9,999; Multiple users—Rs 14,999
+ Huge variety of templates to choose from while creating a new company
— Presents a rigid frame to work with

Simple Accounting Pro		A-				
Performance		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Features		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Ease of Use		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶
Overall		▶	▶	▶	▶	▶

Profile



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Bachelor of Commerce, Bombay University in April 1990
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Prakash Marathe started his practice as an Accountant and Tax Consultant in 1995, and he has 13 years of experience in the field.

Marathe provides complete solutions including day-to-day accounting, and advice on direct and indirect taxation. He heads a team of 15, and his practice includes accounting, income tax, sales tax, service tax, partnership registration, company

formation, company law matters, etc. His services in direct and indirect taxation ranges from registration to assessments and appeals.

He is one of the accounting experts who gave us an expert's opinion.